

VARSHA IYER

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Dear recruiter,

I am a second-year student of conference interpreting at Ruprecht Karls University, Heidelberg, and I hope to earn valuable insight into the working of the DGT as a Blue Book trainee.

Having grown up in different cities in India—each with its own regional language—I moved to Germany in 2018 after I married a German citizen. At the time, I already possessed a Bachelor's degree in psychology, economics and sociology. Within a year, I had learned German well enough to enrol in a Bachelor's degree in linguistics. I completed my degree in 2022 with a major in psycholinguistics/neurolinguistics and a minor in computational linguistics. Furthermore, I learned French and completed an exchange semester in Strasbourg. Since October 2022, I am a student of conference interpreting with the language combination English-German-French. In addition to those, I also speak Tamil and Hindi fluently and understand a handful of other Indian languages.

Before and during my time in Germany, I was able to gather initial work experience in a variety of settings. For instance, my internship at Goldman Sachs in 2017 offered insight into operational support in a major banking and investment firm. My role in 2021 as a student trainee at a language consultant company in Düsseldorf allowed me to become familiar with terminology management. In addition to soft skills I acquired at these and other positions, years of university-level studies have conferred upon me a knack for analytical thinking. Most recently, I was *chef de cabine* for the English booth, responsible for organising the roster for a semester-long weekly conference. Working effectively in a team and taking on leadership roles when required are lessons I learned during my time at university. I am certain that these qualities, in addition to my native command of English, fit the profile you are looking for.

My interests go beyond topics introduced in a classroom setting and cover, among others, law and politics. In the current semester, I have taken additional classes to get familiar with 'legalese' in my working languages. In the future, I hope to interpret for an EU institution. I remember the exact moment I realised how important this goal is—at Multilingualism Day in Brussels in 2022. One of the interpreters I spoke to that day talked to me about the joy she feels in meeting the next generation of interpreters—what I have since hoped to become part of. I am certain that this internship would dovetail perfectly with my personal and professional goals. I am happy to discuss any questions you may have in a personal interview.

Hoping to receive a positive response from you,

Warm regards,



Varsha Iyer